



HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate 004

Exam Prep Course

Bryan Krausen

Why Learn Terraform?



**66% of Organizations are
Increasing Cloud Spend
YoY**

Organizations are continuing to migrate workloads to one or more public cloud providers.



**79% of Organizations have
or are Planning Multi-Cloud
Deployments**

Management of multi-cloud environments requires cloud-agnostic solutions.



**64% of Organizations are
Experiencing a Shortage
of Skilled Staff**

Don't have the staff expertise they need to support their cloud infrastructure strategy.

How This Course Will Transform Your Skills

Gain Real Skills, Build Confidence, and Open New Doors in
Cloud Infrastructure



Hands-On Learning, Fast Results

Get practical experience with real-world Terraform scenarios from the start. You'll build and manage infrastructure right away, gaining skills you can apply immediately.



Confidence in Infrastructure Automation

By the end, you'll feel confident using Terraform to automate and manage cloud infrastructure, laying a solid foundation for advanced cloud projects.



Unlock Opportunities in Your Cloud Career

Terraform is a critical skill in the cloud ecosystem, and this course will give you the edge to stand out, whether you're looking to advance or break into cloud roles.

WELCOME



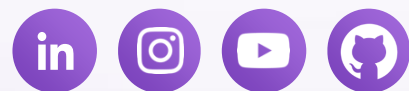
👉 HASHICONF 2024

INSTRUCTOR

Bryan Krausen



Welcome! I'm a Premier Instructor, a HashiCorp Ambassador, and a seasoned technologist who is passionate about cloud infrastructure and security. I help organizations realize the potential of HashiCorp's tools.



btk.me/btk

Why Trust Me?



I Consulted with VERY Large Organizations

During my (many) years of consulting on HashiCorp, I've designed, implemented, fixed, and managed it all 😊



I'm VERY Involved with the Community

I've spoken at 10+ HashiCorp User Groups (HUGs), 5 x HashiConf conferences, and I am one of three people who has been a HashiCorp Ambassador since the start



I Help Write HashiCorp Certification Exams

I've contributed to EVERY single certification exam that HashiCorp offers and continue to do so...



How Do We Get There?

A Variety of Content to Teach, Show, and Get you Hands-On Experience



Lectures to Build **Understanding**

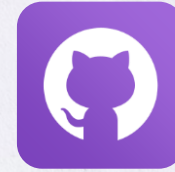


Demos for **Real-World Examples**



Hands-On Labs to **Apply Skills**





Access All Course Code on GitHub

All code used in this course is published in a GitHub repository, so you can follow along, review, and experiment with every example provided.

github.com/btkrausen/hashicorp



Udemy In-Course Hands-On Labs



**Preferred
Method**



**Integrated Directly
Into The Course in
Your Browser**



**Isolated
Environment for
Hands-On Lab or
Experimenting**



**All Prerequisites
and Code are
Preloaded for You**



HashiCorp Terraform Hands-On Labs

Get access to FREE hands-on labs to practice with Terraform configurations, settings, and components...all right in your browser using GitHub Codespaces.

github.com/btkrausen/terraform-associate-labs



Learning Terraform: Tips for Your Journey



Start Small and Build Gradually

Learning Terraform can feel overwhelming but remember that every small step adds up.



Mistakes Are Part of the Process

Errors are expected and even helpful. Don't be discouraged if things don't work right away. Debugging is a great way to deepen your understanding.



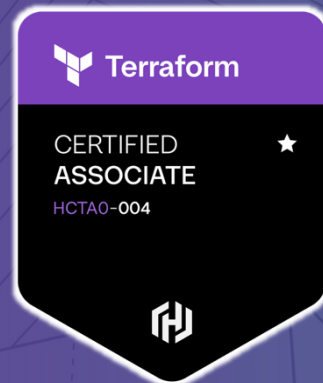
Ask Questions and Seek Community

You're not alone on this journey. Reach out for help when you need it, whether in the Q&A, forums, or with peers.



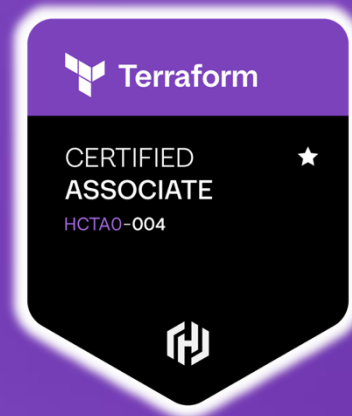


LET'S GET! STARTED!



Terraform Associate 004 Certification

Everything You Need to Know



The Value of Terraform Associate Certification



Industry Recognized Credential

Often preferred or required for many modern DevOps-related or infrastructure roles



Opens Doors to Cloud Engineering Roles

Demonstrates commitment to professional development and your skillsets.



Validates Your Foundational Terraform and IaC Skills

Potential (and current) employers want to know that you can develop and manage Terraform and IaC workflows.



Is This Exam Right for You?

Ideal Candidates:

- Cloud Engineers & DevOps Professionals
- Recommended to have 6+ Months of Terraform Experience (not a hard requirement)
- Solid practice with all objectives/features in a lab environment
- Basic terminal skills
- Understanding of cloud architecture fundamentals

Exam Essentials



Duration: 60 Minutes*



Delivery: Online Proctored (Certiverse)



Language: English Only



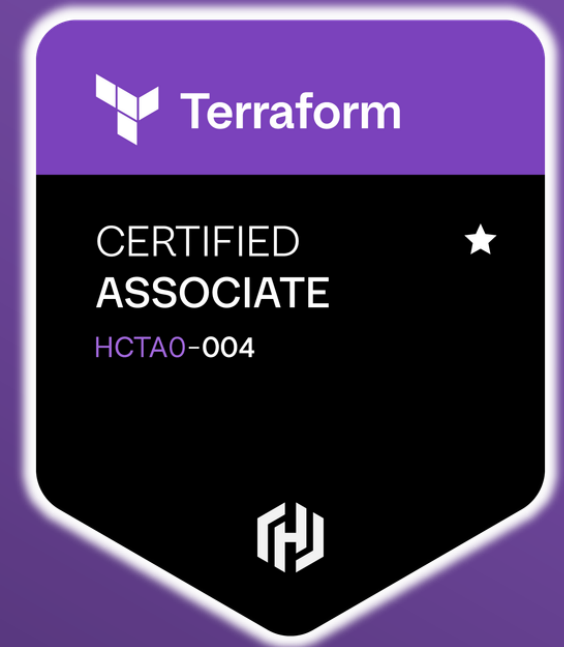
Cost: \$70.50 USD (No free retake)



Validity: Two-years (retake the exam to extend**)



Results: Immediate Pass/Fail Result



* Non-Native English Speakers can request additional time during registration

** Extend by passing the Terraform Professional

Exam Format

What Type of Questions Should You Expect on the Exam?



Multiple Choice (one answer)



Multi-Select (multiple answers)

Questions will indicate how many to choose



True/False Questions

- Cloud-Agnostic but Mentions Different Platforms
- Scenario and Code-Based Questions
- Not Intentionally Tricky



Exam Logistics

Scheduling and Delivery



Book through HashiCorp Certification Portal

developer.hashicorp.com/certifications/signin



There is a check-in Process Before You Start

Government ID Required (must match registration)



Quiet, Private Room with Stable Internet

Seriously, make sure people aren't walking in as you're taking your exam



Webcam and Microphone Needed

Proctor will be watching you. Software will alert if your eyes continuously move off screen, etc.



EXAM OBJECTIVES

Objective 1

Infrastructure as Code (IaC) with Terraform

Objective 2

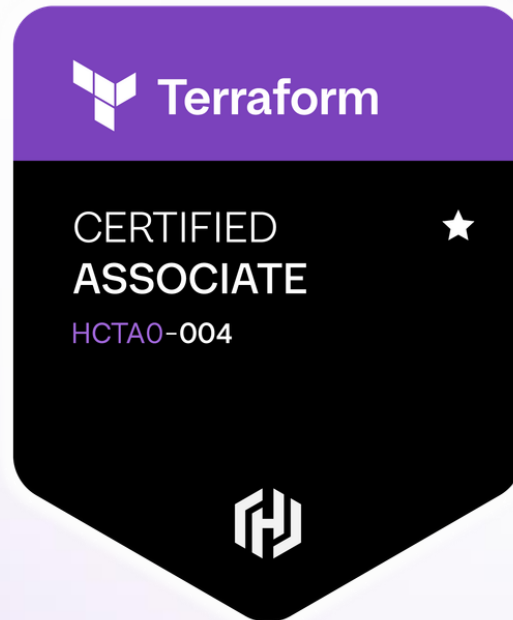
Terraform Fundamentals

Objective 3

Core Terraform Workflow

Objective 4

Terraform Configuration



Objective 5

Terraform Modules

Objective 6

Terraform State Management

Objective 7

Maintain Infrastructure with Terraform

Objective 8

HCP Terraform



What's Changed?

Differences Between Terraform Associate 003 and 004

Bryan Krausen



Terraform Associate 004

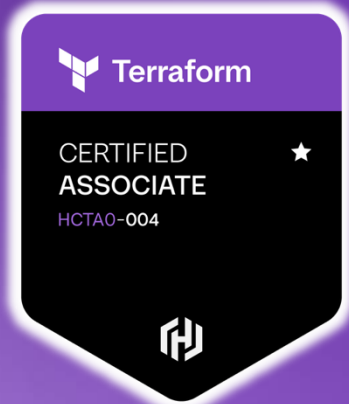
- The Terraform Associate 003 was retired in January 2026 in favor of the newer Terraform Associate 004.
- The last day to take 003 was January 8, 2026.
- Moving forward, all Terraform Associate will be on the 004 exam version.



What Stays the Same?

The core exam structure remains unchanged. Same format, same delivery, same question types.

Approximately 70% of content overlaps between versions.



Similar but Reorganized Objectives

Lots carried over, but there are additional sub-objectives to cover more modern features



60-Minute Testing Format

Same number of questions, same timeframe to take your exam



Same Type of Questions

Multiple choice, multi-select, and true/false
I do believe they removed any fill-in-the-blank



Online Proctored Delivery

In 2025, HashiCorp did drop PSI in favor of using Certiverse for delivery (better experience)



Same Two-year Validity

Either the 003 or the 004 gets you a Terraform Associate certification valid for 2 years

Four Major Additions to the Terraform Associate 004



Explicit Dependencies & Lifecycle Rules

Updates include the `depends_on` and `create_before_destroy` lifecycle rules.

Custom Validation Conditions

Know how to validate configurations using conditions, like the `validate` block for input variables.

Ephemeral Values & Write-Only Arguments

Know how to protect sensitive data and keep it out of state using ephemeral values and write-only arguments.

Expanded HCP Terraform Coverage

Now includes more HCP Terraform features, such as workspaces, projects, governance, collaboration tools, and more.

What This Means for You!

If you Studied and Passed TA 003:



Most of Your Knowledge Transfers



Focus on the Four New Areas



Review and Use the HCP Terraform Features

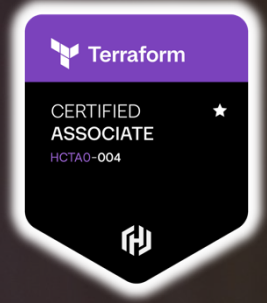




Your Path to Certification

Study Plans that
Work

Bryan Krausen



Why People Fail the Exam

-  **Passive Reading without Hands-On Practice**
-  **No Timeline or Accountability**
-  **Studying Everything Equally (not focusing on gaps)**
-  **Never Actually Booking the Exam**
-  **Memorizing Practice Exams**

There's a Better Way!

Using a strategic, timeline-driven approach can help make you more successful.



Choose a Pathway Based on Experience

You likely have some knowledge that applies to the exam



Book Your Exam Date NOW

Make the Ultimate Commitment and set a Target Date



Focus on Weak Areas

Don't Study Everything Equally, Focus on Things You Don't Know



70% Hands-On Practice, 30% Theory

Hands-On Practice is Proven to Help You Learn and Remember



Structure Weekly Schedule

Based on the Exam Date, Plan out Your Weeks to Ensure You Stay on Track



Pick Your Path to Success



Beginner

- ✓ Little to No Terraform Experience
- ✓ 8-12 Weeks
- ✓ Full Coverage of All Objectives



Practitioner

- ✓ Some Terraform Experience
- ✓ 4-6 Weeks
- ✓ Focus on Gaps + HCP Terraform

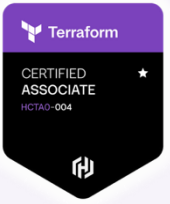


Experienced

- ✓ Regular Terraform User
- ✓ 2-3 Weeks
- ✓ Focus on 004 Updates and Exam Prep

Beginner Pathway

Building Skills from Zero to Terraform Certified



Weeks 1-3

Foundations

- **Objectives 1-2:** IaC Concepts and Fundamentals
- **Hands-On:** First Resources and Using Basic Workflow
- **Milestone:** Using Basic Configurations

Weeks 8-10

Advanced Skills

- **Objectives 5-8:** Modules, State, HCP Terraform
- **Hands-On:** Build Modules, Use Remote State
- **Milestone:** Understanding State and Modules

Weeks 4-7

Core Skills

- **Objectives 3-4:** Workflow and Configuration
- **Hands-On:** Multi-Resource Deployments
- **Milestone:** Write Configurations From Scratch

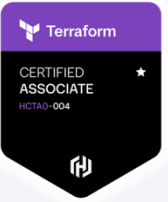
Weeks 11-12

Exam Preparation

- **Practice Exams:** Use Exams to Identify Gaps
- **Review Weak Areas:** Read Docs, Practice
- **Take Your Exam!**

Practitioner Pathway

Fill in the Gaps and Formalize Knowledge



Start with a Practice Exam

If you are already using Terraform, use practice exams to identify weak objectives/areas and ensure you've got the fundamentals down.

Deep Dive of 2-3 Weakest Subjects and 004-specific content (lifecycle, validation, ephemeral)



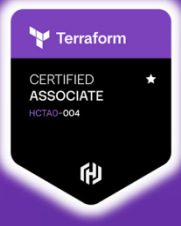
Build Complete Demo Environments and Practice All Workflows. Create Modules from Scratch



Integrate Workflows with HCP Terraform



Take Multiple Full Practice Exams for Final Gap Identification



Experienced Pathway

Experienced Users Have 6+ Months of Experience Using Terraform in a Production Environment.

Comfortable Developing Multi-Resource and/or Multi-Cloud Terraform Configurations and Using Modules.



Focus on 004 Additions

depends_on, lifecycle, validation, ephemeral and write-only, HCP Terraform



Multiple Practice Exams

Identify any Specific Gaps with Videos and Documentation, Deep Dive into HCP Terraform



Timed Practice Exams

Final Confidence Building, Practice taking the test under real conditions

The Most Important Rule

The 70/30 Rule

Do NOT underestimate hands-on practice. Deploy free resources, break things, fix it, practice different configurations.

You CANNOT learn Terraform by reading alone!



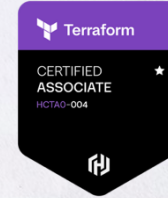
70% - Hands-On Practice

- Write actual configurations
- Deploy real resources
- Break things and fix them
- Practice CLI commands
- Work through error messages



30% - Theory and Reading

- Documentation Review
- Video content
- Concept understanding



Book Your Exam!

Don't wait until you 'feel ready.' Pick your pathway, add the study time, and **book your exam TODAY.**

- ✓ Creates a hard deadline (no more "I'll do it someday")
- ✓ Gives you skin in the game (\$70.50 investment)
- ✓ Motivates consistent study (exam is coming!)
- ✓ Prevents endless preparation without action